Impression weighted memory design

Part 2 Preservation compression and relevance
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This follow-up adds distinctions to Part 1 without replacing it. The working proposal is to preserve history, vary how compactly it is represented, and let the current purpose determine what is expanded into attention. These are design intentions, not demonstrated capabilities.

Preservation is not constant attention

Rick proposes avoiding deletion as the default response to lower relevance. Instead, memories could have more or less compact representations. The stored record, its retrieval priority and the amount placed in active attention are separate concerns. Less present in attention need not mean deleted.

Compression has different guarantees

Lossless compression permits exact reconstruction of the encoded source, but achievable ratios depend on the data. It cannot promise arbitrary or unlimited compression of every record.

A lossy summary discards detail and cannot guarantee recovering it from the summary alone. If exact recovery matters, retain the original or a losslessly encoded copy elsewhere, and link the summary to that source and its version. Expanding the summary then means retrieving retained information, not inventing what was omitted.

Source retention still needs storage, integrity checks and usable references. Keeping several compact views does not by itself establish perfect recall or exact reconstruction.

An impression can change retrieval priority

Rick's proposed rule allows one high-significance emotional impression to outrank grooves reinforced through frequent use, repetition or past performance. This changes which record is retrieved first; it need not erase or weaken the records ranked below it.

The override should depend on the current task, rather than making emotional significance an unconditional winner. Frequency, recency, performance and significance remain distinct inputs. This is a proposed ranking rule, not a mechanism demonstrated by the conversation.

Relevant for which purpose

Viola's story was the wrong continuation point for resuming the game, but a useful starting point for the memory-design discussion. Its relevance changed with the question, not with the value or existence of the record. A useful system should distinguish "Where do we continue playing?" from "What helps us develop this idea?"